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REAL ESTATE NETWORK

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KEYS TO THE CITY • CITY PAPERS • CHECKLIST

30-Day Lisbon Integration Checklist

Your complete roadmap from arrival to settled

□ Created: March 2026
□ Lisbon & District
2 pages

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This checklist breaks down your first 30 days in Lisbon into actionable steps with clear priorities and deadlines. Follow this timeline to handle legal requirements, set up essential services, explore neighborhoods, and build your network without missing critical deadlines or making expensive mistakes. Each item includes priority level (Critical/Important/Optional) and suggested timeline to keep you on track.

Before Arrival (30 Days Out)

- | | | | |
|--------------------------|---|------------------|----------------|
| ☐ | Book temporary accommodation for first 30 days minimum | CRITICAL | 30 days before |
| ☐ | Research neighborhoods (Lisbon, Cascais, Oeiras, Setúbal) | IMPORTANT | 30 days before |
| ☐ | Airport pickup – Uber, Bolt or Metro | OPTIONAL | 7 days before |

□ PRO TIP

Book your first 30 days in a central neighborhood (Baixa, Chiado, or Saldanha) even if you think you want to live elsewhere. This gives you easy access to government offices, lets you explore different areas on foot, and keeps you close to transport hubs while you get your bearings.



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First Week (Days 1-7)

- | | | | |
|--------------------------|--|------------------|----------|
| ☐ | Apply for NIF at Finanças or through lawyer/accountant | CRITICAL | Days 1-3 |
| ☐ | Get Portuguese SIM card (MEO, NOS, or Vodafone store) or eSim through | IMPORTANT | Day 1-2 |
| ☐ | Buy Viva Viagem card and load monthly pass (€40 for all zones) | IMPORTANT | Day 1-2 |
| ☐ | Visit 3-5 different neighborhoods to compare (ride the 28 tram, walk Alfama) | IMPORTANT | Days 3-7 |

Weeks 2-4 (Days 8-30)

- | | | | | |
|--------------------------|--|------------------|------------|--------------|
| ☐ | Open Portuguese bank account (requires NIF + proof of address) | CRITICAL | Days 10-14 | Notes: _____ |
| ☐ | Register with SNS (National Health Service) at local health center | CRITICAL | Days 14-21 | Notes: _____ |
| ☐ | Find long-term apartment (start viewings in weeks 2-3) | IMPORTANT | Days 14-30 | Notes: _____ |
| ☐ | Join local meetup groups, expat communities, or | OPTIONAL | Days 14-30 | Notes: _____ |

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language exchanges

Key Takeaways

NIF first, everything else follows. You cannot open a bank account, sign a lease, or set up utilities without your NIF. This is your top priority in the first 3 days.

Don't rush the neighborhood decision. Live centrally for the first month while you explore. Most people change their mind about where they want to be after experiencing different areas at different times of day.

Portuguese bureaucracy is slow. Everything takes 2-3x longer than you expect. Start processes early and always have backup plans.

Build your network early. The people you meet in month one often become your closest friends and most valuable contacts. Be intentional about showing up.

Budget 30% more than you think. First-month costs (deposits, temporary housing, setup fees, eating out while apartment hunting) always exceed estimates.

Thinking about making a move?

Book a discovery call to get personalized guidance on your property journey in Portugal:

Email | WhatsApp

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